

Let's try to lay out Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the **traditional doctrine** of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with the existence of a perfectly good God.

“A certain traditional conception of the afterlife is *binary*. After death one proceeds either to heaven or hell. Heaven is very, very good; hell is very, very bad. There are no possibilities for the afterlife other than heaven and hell, and membership in heaven or hell is never indeterminate or a matter of degree. The problem with the binary conception is that it contradicts God's justice. God must employ some criterion to decide who goes to heaven and who goes to hell. No reasonable criterion would be sharp; any reasonable criterion will have borderline cases. But the binary conception of the afterlife allows for no corresponding fuzziness in how the dead are to be treated. Hell must therefore contain people who are nearly indiscernible in relevant respects from people in Heaven. No just God would allow such a monstrously unfair thing.”

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to heaven and hell based on certain properties of those people. We will leave open for now what those properties might be; just to have a name for them, let's call them the **relevant properties**.

Badness

Dichotomy

Non-
universality

Divine
control

Justice

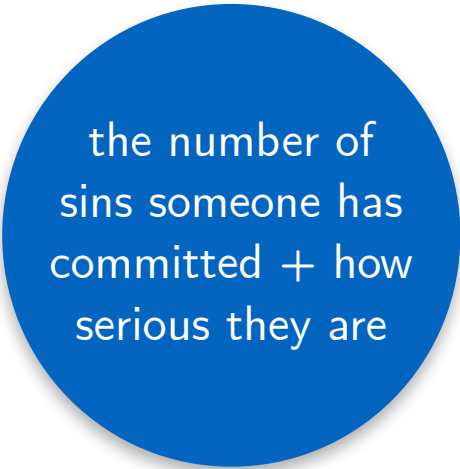
Proportion- ality

Continuity

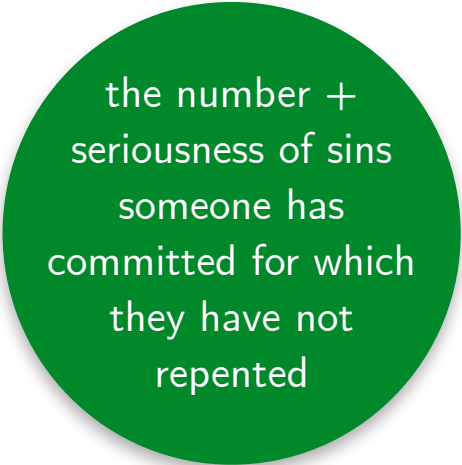
Let's consider candidates.

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

the number of
sins someone has
committed



the number of
sins someone has
committed + how
serious they are

A solid green circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the number + seriousness of sins someone has committed for which they have not repented" is written in a white, sans-serif font, arranged in six lines.

the number +
seriousness of sins
someone has
committed for which
they have not
repented



the person's faith
and trust in God



the person's
decision to be with
God



the
paradox of
heaven and
hell



replies to the
paradox



evil & lives
not worth
living

the existence of a perfectly good God.

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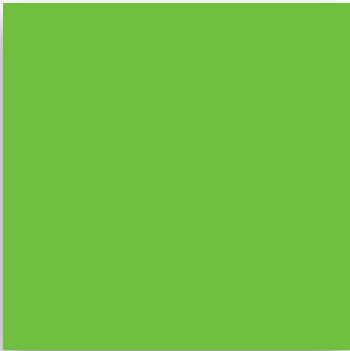
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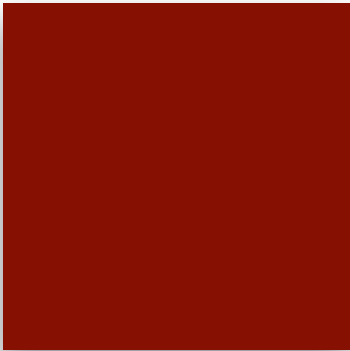


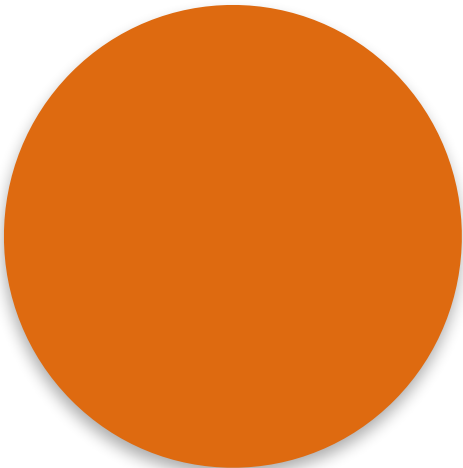


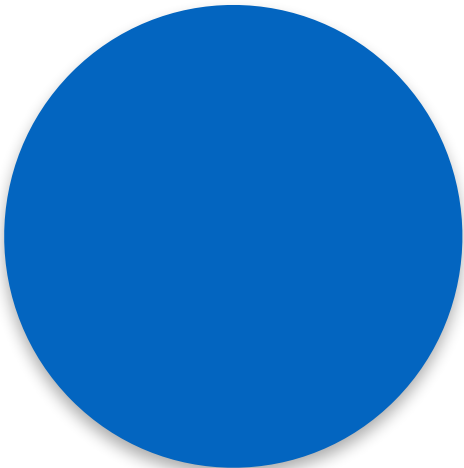


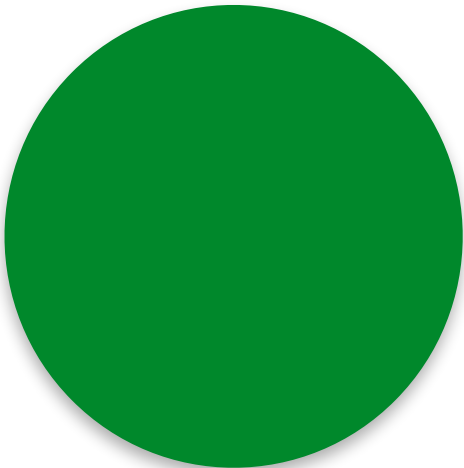


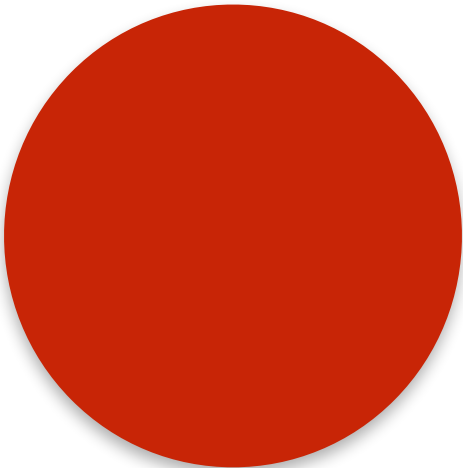








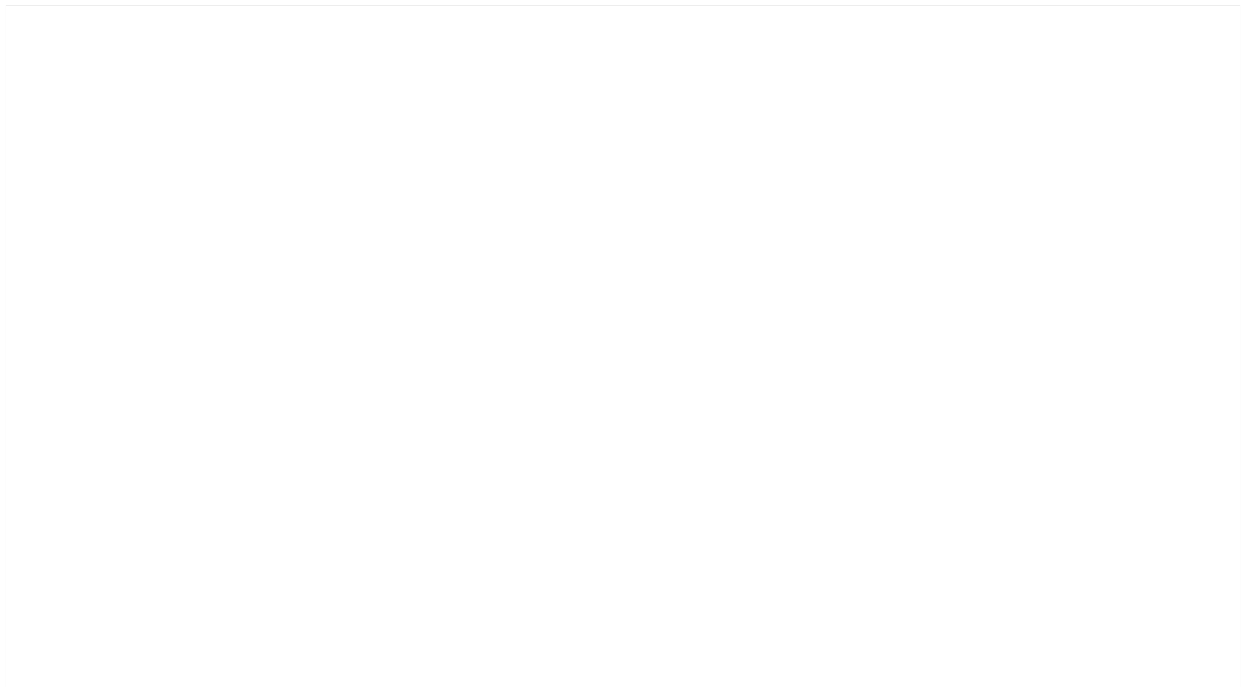






The following passage from the Catechism of the Catholic Church

describes the kind of view wanted to discuss:



1038. The resurrection of all the dead, 'of both the

goats, and he will place the sheep at his right hand,

another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

just and the unjust,' will precede the Last

Judgment. Christ will come "in his glory, and all

but the goats at the left.... and they will go away

all the nations, and he will separate them one from

the angels with him... Before him will be gathered

into external punishment, but the rights into

eternis in die !!

One topic often associated with belief in God is the topic of life after death.

perfectly good Good?

Our first question today is: what we are told about life after death by

many of the major monotheistic religions compatible with the existence of a



the Last Judgment. . . Christ will come "in

his glory, and all the angels with him . . .

they will go away into eternal punishment,

both the just and the unjust," will proceed

and the wild sheep are then from another

right hand, but the goat at the left... and

but the rights are all in it.

as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

goals, and the willpower that she has

Before him will be gathered all the nations,

1038. The reservation of the dead, "of

This certainly seems like a picture according to which, after death, God passes

judgement on all of us, and on the basis of our life, decides that some of us will

got to heaven forever, and some others to hell forever. (If not 'forever', then the

talk of the last judgment wouldn't make much sense.)

Turned-in showed why it is plausible that respo to the argument from evil

view of life after death we get here on pain of being perfectly good?

must depend on the possibility of life after death. We will now ask: is the kind of











evil & lives
not worth
living

Badness

Divine
control

Justice

Continuity

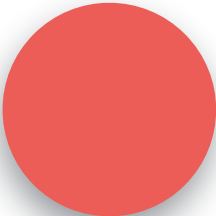
seems to give the defender of the afterlife further main options.



It seems difficult to deny Justice, Badness, or Divine Control. So that



replies to the
paradox





the
paradox of
heaven and
hell

